Interview Transcript
Interviewee: P1
Interviewer: P0

Interviewer: Thank you for participating in this user interview. The purpose of this interview is to better understand how people use fitness app. In this interview, I want to focus on your experience with fitness app. Therefore, there's no right or wrong answer. This interview is being recorded and conduct for research only. If you have any concerns about data privacy or how your response will be used, please feel free to ask. Before we begin, please say your name and your age.

Interviewee: OK, my name is P1 and I'm AGE years old.

Interviewer: OK, first could you start by telling me your exercise habits? Like how often do you exercise?

Interviewee: OK. So, I go to the gym about six days a week and the majority of that is weightlifting. And I follow a push, pull, legs routine. So that's usually like Monday I'll do push, next day I do pull, then I'll do legs, and then I'll take a rest day and then repeat basically.

push. pull legs.

Interviewer: Are there any potentials would you disturb your fitness plan, things that could potentially disturb method?

Things that disturb homework / bad sleep / less eat / travel.

Interviewee: Yeah, mostly the things that disturb my fitness plan now are if I don't sleep well the night before, then it makes it hard for me to go to the gym if I haven't. If I didn't eat before I go to the gym, that I find that I feel weaker. Traveling definitely gets in the way of my fitness like if I'm. I went on a little vacation this past week, and I didn't go to the gym at all because there were no gyms. What else. I would say school sometimes gets in the way. Like, I remember, especially during near finals week last semester, I really stopped going to the gym as much because I just had way too much work, and that took priority over fitness.

Interviewer: How do you compensate?

Interviewee: Compensate this? I guess I kind of think about it in a way that if I take like a week off or something, it's not that bad. And in fact, that can sometimes be good for you, just giving your muscles a break and stuff, especially because working out six days a week is a lot, a lot of stress on the body. So sometimes I think about it like that. And when I'm on these breaks or there's something, it doesn't even have to be the travel, just kind of generally anything that gets in the way, I just try to stay consistent with the other things that affect fitness, which would be like my diet and my sleep and whatever supplements I'm taking, I just continue to do that. And yeah, it usually is.

flexible workout plan / alternative.

disturb can be good.

Interviewer: It's fine.

Interviewee: Yeah.

Interviewer: What time of day do you usually work out?

time for exercise.

Interviewee: I prefer to work kind of like after I've had breakfast ~~and I'm kind of a night owl, so~~ I wake up kind of late. So that's usually around like noon or like 1:00 PM or something like that. But generally, I just like to work out before it's nighttime. I don't like working out at nighttime because it's, I don't know, for some reason it's a little depressing to me to like to go out of the gym and it's like dark out and yeah, yeah, I don't know, you're just super sleepy and yeah, the day's like basically over it.

prefer daylight rather night time

Interviewer: And what are your primary motivations for exercising?

Interviewee: My primary motivations would be being healthy, being athletic, and I guess, like, looking good.

healthy / athletic

Interviewer: What are the biggest challenges you face in maintaining a consistent fitness routine as a college student?

Interviewee: So as a college student, I think the big one would be the academics. When it's getting near the end of the semester and work is really starting to pick up, that's when I noticed that I start to skip out on the gym more. But something that's new to me is like as an international college student is kind of adapting to this new place and kind of having more responsibilities. Like my school at home we have like a dining hall and we pay for that so all the food is pre made, which is super nice. But here it's like I'm having to make my own food and feed myself. And I, I think I've, I've like adapted now. But at the start that was definitely like it was harder because it was just another thing that I had to deal with.

new environment + school homework. + eat habit chang-

Interviewer: And now, we're going to talk about the last of time you exercise and what you were doing.

Interviewee: So that was this morning. I was doing a push day. So that's primarily I'm working out my chest, my shoulders and my triceps.

chest, shoulders. triceps.

Interviewer: And where did you exercise?

where.

Interviewee: I worked at the Pleasance Gym. OK, owned by the University of Edinburgh.

Interviewer: And then how do you feel about the surroundings of the gym?

feel about surroundings?

Interviewee: Yeah, it's a very nice gym. I will say it does get pretty packed a lot, which can be annoying. And that definitely effects my motivation, especially on like the more like harder days, like leg day where like if I am trying to do an exercise but there's like a line with like three people in it, I'll just like skip out on the exercise because I just don't wanna wait.

nice
packed
annoying

Interviewer: Oh, OK.

Interviewee: Which can, I mean, that's just like bad, you know, and that's purely because there's people there, I guess.

train alone

Interviewer: Who did you exercise with?

Interviewee: I just go by myself because, yeah, I have a very like specific routine I like to do and yeah, I like to follow it.

Interviewer: And then do you have a trainer?

Interviewee: I do. I have a trainer now.

Interviewer: OK, then what do you think about having a trainer?

trainer is helpful.

Interviewee: I think having a trainer is great. I mean, it could take a lot of the pressure off getting into the gym and starting the gym or even just consistently going to the gym if you don't have to think about what your workout plan is. Yeah, I bet that's like, so much easier and you can focus a lot more of your energy on the diet, the sleep and like, other factors.

Interviewer: Did you encounter any difficulties, like feeling tired or not?

drink can fix

energy

bad sleep
eat not well.

Interviewee: Well, in my last time? Let's see, yeah, I guess there were, there were a few exercises like I do like lateral raises, which I'm like having trouble making progress on. And I didn't really get good quality sleep last night. So I noticed that my strength was down a little bit. But I had like I had breakfast before, and I had like an energy drink this morning. So that kind of worked to fix that a little bit. And it was, it was a pretty good workout, yeah.

Interviewer: How did you decide which exercise you wanted to do?

Interviewee: So that's pretty much based off like, I watch this YouTube named Jeff Nippert and he does all these like science based, like workout routines. And I pretty much just look at what he does and copy it and I choose the exercises that I've like that feel good to me that he also advocates for. So yeah.

public tutorial video

Interviewer: Cool. Do you have a plan, like a workout plan?

workout routines

Interviewee: Yeah. I have, I have like a workout routine that I try to maintain consistently. And yeah, it's like, like I mentioned before, the push, pull legs. And it's I do the same exact exercises for every push, pull, legs. Or actually I have kind of like two sets. It's like an A and a B set. So, it's push for legs one and push for legs 2. And I switch out some exercises. But yeah.

Interviewer: So, are you making your plan by yourself?

Interviewee: Yeah, I get, yeah, I do whatever my own research and like I watch all those YouTube videos and look at the studies and stuff and I do my own research on myself by like what feels good when I work out. So yeah.

Interviewer: OK, now we're going to talk about the tracking tools you use. What tracking tools are you using?

not most efficie

Interviewee: So I track my workout progress on Google Sheets. And I know it's not like the most efficient method, but I've just been doing it pretty much the entire time I've been working out, which is and but how it works is like I have a single column. The top of the column is whatever that exercise is. And then each of the following columns below have the amount of sets I did, the amount of reps per set, and the weight I was doing. So it's just basically a huge Google sheet with like a bunch of different exercises and the progress. So when I'm working out, I just go look at that and I add in a new one, which is like the goal I'm trying to hit.

Google sheets.

Interviewer: Then how did you decide to use this tool?

financial issue.

Interviewee: I originally tried out a few apps like back in the like high school. But to actually like use the progress in those apps, you have to pay for it. And, like, I was a, like, high school student, so I didn't really have, like, money to do that. So I just was like, OK, I'll find my own way to do it. And I just did that with the Google Sheets, and it's worked OK right now.

Interviewer: Have you faced any difficulties or frustrations while using it?

Interviewee: Yeah. I mean, sometimes I'll forget to write down what I was working out on. And, like, it takes some time. Like, when I'm moving to my next exercise from the past one, I'm like, I have to, like, find it. I have to like search through this big list and sometimes I, I like label stuff wrong. So I'm, I don't really know if that's the exercise I was doing it in. And one of the biggest problems is that so there are machines that use single pulley systems and two pulley systems. So a single pulley of like 25 lbs to A2 pulley system would feel like 12 1/2 lbs. So I have to kind of adjust for that. So if I ever like switch gyms and I start switch, switching between those, it kind of messes up my data. And also switching from American measurement systems to whatever UK measurement system that messes up too, because I switched from pounds to KG.

easy to forget.
switch measurem
not flexible/
inconvenien

Interviewer: And would you say that it provides valuable insights for your health and performance, the Google Sheets you use?

Interviewee: Yeah, I think so. I mean, it gets the job of tracking, tracking my progress done. Even though it's like a little unorganized it it's like it's good enough.

tracking / record is good.

Interviewer: Do you think it's help you stay motivated?

Interviewee: Yeah, definitely. I probably, I don't think I would be working out if I couldn't keep track of it because that's kind of like one of the core ideas of like working out for me is like the progressive overload. And like, that's because I'm trying to like build muscle and you need to be making progress and like lifting heavier weights to like cause hypertrophy and build muscle.

Interviewer: Would you be interested in a system that integrates fitness tracking with academic schedules? So what would that be like?

Interviewee: For example, how would that like apply during my final's week, for example. Like would it find it like I would be able to put my information in on my glasses and it would like allocate some time for me or like, yeah, if I if I didn't have enough time to do one of my full workouts, it could like give me like a smaller one or something like that. Yeah, I'd be interested in that.

more:
better plan
organizatio

Interviewer: OK then how do you feel about social or community-based features in some fitness apps?

Interviewee: Yeah, I think that would be super cool. Just another like channel of motivation, I would say. I think, yeah, if I could like share what was on my Google Sheets and like, look at other people's progress, I think that would be a huge motivator. Add a little like friendly competition and stuff like that.

community featur

Interviewer: And would you use AI driving suggestions for workout optimization and recovery tracking?

Interviewee: Yeah, if I could like preview them and stuff, then yeah, I definitely would.

third party

Interviewer: What is one key improvement you would like to say in fitness tracking of technology?

Interviewee: Yeah, I guess kind of thing that prevented me from getting into it in the first place and finding my own way was like the paywalls. I mean, I understand that like companies and apps and stuff like they have to make money somehow, but I don't know, it would be nice to be able to like track my progress somewhat without paying.

without paying is better

Interviewer: I think I should end up here. Is anything else you would like to share?

Interviewee: No, I don't. I don't think so.

Interviewer: Thank you for your time.

Interviewee: Yeah, of course.

Interview Transcript
Interviewee: P2
Interviewer: P0

Interviewer: Thank you for participating in this user interview. The purpose of this interview is to better understand how people use fitness app. In this interview, I want to focus on your experience with fitness app. Therefore, there's no right or wrong answer. This interview is being recorded and conducted for research only. If you have any concerns about data privacy or how your response will be used, please feel free to ask. Before we begin, please say your name and your age.

Interviewee: OK, my name is P2 and I'm AGE years old.

Interviewer: OK, so first could you start by telling me your exercise habits? How often do you exercise?

Interviewee: OK, I exercise regularly, ~~every week, three times a week~~, mostly strength training. So I go to the gym for around one to two hours per day and then after strength training, I do cardio, either walking or I do the stair master for around 30 minutes. And that's it.

3 times a week
2hrs per day.

strength training.
working.
cardio.

Interviewer: Are there any potentials would disturb your fitness plan?

Interviewee: Yes, sometimes I am lazy. Sometimes the weather is too cold, and I don't want to go out. Sometimes I'm too busy with my academic courses and I don't have time and so then I would have to catch up with my workouts.

Things that disturb:
cold weather.
being lazy
School workload

Interviewer: Then how can you compensate this?

Interviewee: First of all, I go easy on myself, so I don't pressure myself that, oh, you missed this workout. You have to like to keep up and don't break your workout cycle and all that. But yeah, versus go easy on myself. And then the next week I would just go back to my daily routine. I wouldn't like workout four times or five times. I would still workout three times. Maybe like I do it even harder maybe. So like I put on more weights when I like walk longer on that day. But yeah, that's good.

flexible workout plan.

Interviewer: And what are your primary motivations for exercising?

be healthier
healthy lifestyle

Interviewee: I started because I just wanted to be healthier. I wanted to gain more weight and have more energy. But now that I've reached that goal, it's just maintaining a healthy habit and healthy lifestyle because I feel like right now, I have a lot of activities and I need to make sure that I'm not sick to do all of those. So just being healthy and maintaining a good habit is my priority.

Interviewer: OK, cool. What are the biggest challenges you face in maintaining a consistent fitness routine as a college student?

external factors.

Interviewee: External factors such as too much workload, academic courses and group projects and all that work, that's like the main factor. So just the time management and then also keeping my health in check. Like if I'm too lazy that day or if I'm not feeling well, then that's all my work. I was delayed. And then there's also the weather because it's pretty cold here during winter and sometimes it's not ideal to go outside in such a cold and windy day. But if it is like too cold, I try to do my workouts at home. So like home workouts just keep my heart rate up for that day.

Interviewer: Now we're gonna talk about the last time you exercised. Tell me more details on what you were doing.

Interviewee: The last time I exercised was few days ago. That was strength train again. I did legs. So I tried to hit every muscle group. So each workout would focus on one muscle group and I would do like a few workouts to hit all muscle groups and then did cardio, then go back home.

cardio
leg.
strength.

Interviewer: Where did you exercise?

Interviewee: I go to the gym at Pleasance, and I usually go before class, so around ~~9:00 AM~~ until 1:00 PM.

time for exercise: morning.

Interviewer: OK, how do you feel about the surroundings?

Interviewee: At first, I was ~~intimidated~~ because, well, I when I first started, because I was so small and like everyone at the gym was like so big. They can lift heavy weights, they look, but they're friendly. I was just into it, and I was a girl too. So like it was so much pressure. But because I started with a personal trainer, so he guided me through the workouts, and I felt more comfortable being at the gym. And that was two years ago. And now that I've become even more comfortable, I'm pretty adjusted with the gym people and the surrounding.

feel about surrounding

As long as I like. If I just don't annoy anyone and be respectful, that's fine.

Interviewer: Do you have a trainer, or do you have partner?

Interviewee: I did start with a personal trainer for six months and then the rest of the way I did it myself.

Interviewer: How do you think about having a trainer?

Interviewee: Oh, I like it. It helps because I don't have to think. I just have to show up. And then do whatever they told me to. Sometimes setting up the weights is like the most tiring part of working out, and so not having to do that was really nice. But you do have to pay a lot of time.

trainer could be supportive.

financial worry

Interviewer: Did you encounter any difficulties, for example, feeling tired or hurt?

Interviewee: No, because I am very mindful of what my body can do. So if I start to feel uncomfortable, I would stop and not increase the weight or take rest. So I really listen to my body in terms of like, if I feel pain or anything, I do have a medical condition in my spine and that hinders me from lifting too much. So that's why I have to be really mindful of how much I lift because I don't wanna get injured by trying to stay healthy.

self medical condition
mindful about body

Interviewer: Yeah, that's important.

Interviewee: Yeah.

Interviewer: How did you decide which exercise you wanted to do?

Interviewee: So because I did cause I do like 3 * a week, I divide it into like muscle groups. So I would do back muscles and then I would do the chest muscles and then the leg. And then so the days are like I wake up the next day I rest, the next day I wake up, the next day I rest. Just make sure that those muscles have time to rest and then do another muscle group but different.

sternerne of workout

Interviewer: OK, so you do have a plan.

Interviewee: It was from my personal trainer. And once I was not with them, I just remembered what they taught me and did the same thing.

Interviewer: OK, and now we're gonna talk about the tools you are using to track your exercise. Do you currently use any exercise tracking tools?

tracking tools

Interviewee: Yes, I use Hevy which is to track my sets and repetitions from workouts at the gym and then when I do cardio, I also use either Strava or Nike Run Club app to track my pace and then also monitor how much I ran and where I ran.

Hevy
Strava
Nike Run club.

Interviewer: How did you find those apps?

Interviewee: They helped me gain insights about my progress and like the trends, and that made me feel accomplished and that's why I kept using the applications. It also allowed me to like build a community and interact with my friends who also uses the apps because I knew Strava and Nike run Club and Hevy from my friends. If it weren't for them, I wouldn't be using it.

progress record.
trend.
community feature

Interviewer: OK, what features do you use the most in those tools?

Interviewee: For Heavy, I use it to plan my workouts. So, for example, if it's pull day, I would have already planned the workouts for pulls. So, if it's like a lat pull down, four sets, 10 repetitions each and like 35 kilograms each set. So everything is planned. And then I track the time also. And then I could see my workout logs at Hevy, like how much kilograms did I lift that day. And then I see the progress. And then first rubber Nike Run Club, I would see my pace like the progress. And because I can interact with my friends and they share their results also on social media, I could compare, which is unhealthy, could compare my results with theirs. And I tracked kilometres because I tried to aim about 5 per week. That's impossible. But I usually run only two kilometres by track.

unhealthy comparsion

Interviewer: Have you faced any difficulties or frustrations while using it?

Interviewee: For Hevy, yes, because you have to be consistent with like pressing like oh, I've done that, I've done that, I've done that for the plans. And so even though I made progress like looking in the mirror, but I didn't write it on my phone, then I would still feel not accomplished to make sense. And for Strava, because it's easy to compare with other people by numbers, it's also very toxic, right?

information that cannot be textualiz

Interviewer: How would you say that it provides valuable insights for your health and performance?

Interviewee: It does, but because it is a tool, it just supports my habits. It's not like the main factor to drive me or motivate me to work out. What do motivate me is just me looking in the mirror and me feeling good by myself. So the tools are just to like, it's just a like an additional thing to give me insights about myself.

tracking is not the main motivat

Y

Interviewer: Do you think it help you to stay motivated?

Interviewee: It does, especially if I get good feedback from people who also use. It's like my friends, if they use the app and they give me a good word that that makes me well, thank you.

good feedback.

Interviewer: Would you be interested in a system that integrates fitness tracking with academic schedule?

Interviewee: So like planning the workouts in terms of my schedule? Yeah, I wouldn't because then I think that would be like their orchestrating my lifestyle instead of me needing their help when I wanna workout. So maybe AI for when I want to work out and like structuring the workout on that day only would be more beneficial.

prefer self-driven not forced.

Interviewer: OK, how do you feel about social or community-based features in fitness apps?

community-focused.

Interviewee: It's there's negatives and positives for it. The positive side is that, you know, you're building a community, you feel like you're not doing this alone. There's a lot of people who are also struggling. But the negative side is when you start to compare yourself without knowing any other context. So that's

incorrect comparison

Interviewer: Would you use AI driving suggestions for workout optimization and the recovery tracking?

Interviewee: Yes, that would really help actually.

Interviewer: What the one key improvement you would like to see in fitness tracking technology?

Interviewee: I guess like if they could be more not targeted toward. So sometimes the fitness world is toxic because it's like, well, if you eat a doughnut, then you're gonna become fat. If you miss a workout, you're gonna bubble bug be more mindful. So like the app could suggest like it's OK to take a list using words like that. And then they could also, like, guide me especially for beginners. So like for running because I am a beginner, they could like, guide me on like, the good form of running, how my foot should land, how my pace should be and like, it just, you know, the important stuff when you start running.

more: looser value orientation

Interviewer: I think I should end up here. Is there anything you want to share?

Interviewee: No.

Interviewer: OK. Thank you for your time.

Interviewee: Thank you.